Reports on substances

10a

1 The table below provides information about four different substances. Choose one substance to write a report about.

Information	Water	Oxygen gas	Iron	Milk
Melting point (°C)	0	-219	1 536	-1
Boiling point (°C)	100	-183	2 861	101
State of matter*	Liquid	Gas	Solid	Liquid
Colour	Clear	Clear	Silver, shiny	White, opaque
Weight of 1 L	1.0 kg	1.5 g	7.8 kg	1.1 kg
Mixture?	No	No	No	Yes
Conductor of electricity?	Poor	No	Good	Poor
Conductor of heat?	Poor	Poor	Good	Poor
Pure substance?	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Source	Rivers, rain	Plants	Iron ores	Cows
Occurrence	Oceans, lakes, ice	Air	Ground	Cows
Chemical symbol	H_2O	O_2	Fe	---
Renewable?	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Recyclable?	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Use 1	Living things need it, as well as food.	Living things respire with it.	Cars, bridges, nails (strength!)	First food for calves
Use 2	Many engines are cooled with it.	Burning of things like wood, coal.	In steel: sinks, cutlery	Nutritious drink for people
Comment 1	70% of a human body is water.	Cell respiration releases energy.	Iron is strong but heavy.	Popular drink for children
Comment 2	97% water on Earth is salt water (a mixture).	Burning is also called combustion.	Iron goes rusty easily; it needs to be protected.	Made into cheese, yoghurt, curd, ice cream

* Note: State of matter is taken as state of matter at room temperature (20°C).

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2 **Collecting information into a scaffold**

Before you start writing your report, you need to collect relevant information into a scaffold. Each box in the scaffold represents one paragraph about a particular aspect. The first scaffold about water with five aspects – one for each paragraph – has been outlined below. The first and second information boxes in the scaffold have been started.

Use the scaffold below the exampe to collect relevant information about the substance you chose.

Example scaffold

Aspect	Information about water
a Classification	*Pure substance; State of matter: liquid*
b Properties	*Melting point 0°C, Boiling point 100°C*
c Production	
d Uses	
e Comments	

Your scaffold

Aspect	Information about:
a	
b	
c	
d	
e	

3 **Ordering your notes**

When you have finished collecting information into your scaffold, number the notes you made in the information column to show the order in which you will write your paragraph sentences.

4 **Writing a report**

Use the ordered information to write the paragraphs about the substance in your workbook.
Remember:

- each paragraph will have the name of the substance near the front
- many sentences will start with the name of the substance or 'It'
- use describing words (adjectives) and linking verbs (like 'has' and 'is').

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